Thy Duong

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Profile

Master's candidate in Politics and Technology, graduating September 2026, with research experience in AI governance, algorithmic accountability, and LLM auditing. My work applies persona-conditioned experimental design, statistical testing, and text analysis to questions of bias and fairness in AI systems, with a specific focus on how model behavior shifts depending on who is asking, and what this means for citizens' trust in the democratic institutions and media systems that increasingly rely on AI-generated output.

Education

Technical University of Munich: MSc Politics and Technology **September 2023 – September 2026**

- German GPA: 1.3
  Specialization: Data & Society

Karlshochschule International University: BA International Relations **2020 – 2023**

- German GPA: 1.7

Higher School of Economics University in Moscow: Exchange Semester **February – July 2022**

Research Experience

Student Research Assistant, TUM School of Social Scienc **March 2026 – October 2026**
Chair of Science and Technology Policy (8 hours/ week)

- Conducting inductive qualitative coding of interview transcripts in MAXQDA, identifying and labeling recurring segments to develop themes grounded in the data
- Transcribing interview recordings for accuracy and completeness prior to analysis

Master's Thesis, TUM School of Social Science **April – September 2026**
Supervisor: Prof. Orestis Papakyriakopoulos

- Designed and executed a comparative audit of geopolitical bias in LLM based fact checking, comparing nine models (US, Chinese, and European blocs) across five contested topics using persona-conditioned prompting
- Built a news scraping and verification pipeline yielding 174 verified articles from Western and Chinese sources across seven outlets
- Ran a full scale study of 71,979 rows across nine model APIs, building a complete Python analysis pipeline (verdict extraction via regex, persona/bloc tagging, chi-square and logistic regression)

Student Research Assistant, TUM School of Social Scienc **December 2025 – September 2026**
Emmy Noether Research Group: The Media Portrayal of Majority and Minority Groups (8 hours/ week)

- Performing intercoder reliability validation tests for textual datasets.
- Providing literature review support, synthesizing academic sources across topics as assigned by the research team.

Student Research Assistant, Max Planck Institute for Social Law and Social Policy **June – September 2025**
Project: PERGAP (10 hours/ week)

- Performing comparative methodology assessment and tool evaluation for legal data retrieval systems on social security policy
- Designed prompt engineering frameworks for structured data extraction from unstructured legal texts

Student Research Assistant, TUM School of Social Science **December 2024 – September 2025**
Project: ClimateVisions (8 hours/ week)

- Conducted text classification and content analysis with R and Python
- Evaluated ML model performance using quantitative metrics (confusion matrix, F1-score)
- Ensured data quality by cleaning and preprocessing quantitative datasets
- Conducted intercoder reliability tests and qualitative coding for climate communication datasets

Student Assistant, Institute of Ethics in Artificial Intelligence **March 2024 – February 2025**

- Updated and edited website with WordPress and organizational tasks
- Engaged in events (e.g. Munich Security Conference Side Event 2025, International AI and Human Rights Summit)
- Assisted AI Ethics Lab at Rutgers University with the AI & Human Rights Index

Research Coursework, Institute of Ethics in Artificial Intelligence **September 2024 – February 2025**
Project: MoralPLai (20 hours/ week)

- Analyzed 56 quantitative studies on LLM ethics and moral psychology using a structured 14-column framework
- Authored an independent study proposal identifying methodological gaps in LLM consistency research

Research Fellow, Boston Global Forum **April – October 2024**
Project: AI World Society

- Carried out research into prominent leaders and their contributions to the current AI landscape.

Student Market Research Team, Impact Hub Karlsruhe **October 2021 – January 2022**

- Set up a market research questionnaire
- Collected data via interviews and Google forms

Additional Experience

Working Student in Operations, Brainbirds GmbH **September 2024 – April 2025**

- Supported the logistics of event planning and trainer assignments
- Developed customer data
- Prepared training materials in seminars

Project Assistant Intern, European Chamber Hungary **January – April 2023**

- Promoted as team leader of the intern team in the first month
- Collected and analyzed macroeconomic data from partner companies
- Assisted with socio-political evaluation and investment opportunities

Conferences

Duong T., & Mai T.-N. (2026). AI Applications and Governance Challenges in Statutory Drafting and Regulatory Compliance: A Comparative Analysis. In *Искусственный интеллект и духовная культура: сборник материалов II Международной научно-практической конференции* [Artificial Intelligence and Spiritual Culture: Proceedings of the II International Scientific and Practical Conference], Vol. 1 (pp. 344–349). St. Petersburg: Scientia. ISBN 978-5-907902-80-0.

Duong, T., & Papakyriakopoulos, O. (Poster presentation, forthcoming September 2026). *Bias in LLM-Based Factchecking: A Geopolitical Audit*. AI: Hype, Hope and Humanity (AIHHH), Erasmus University Rotterdam.

Volunteering Experience

Contributor, International Platform for Crime, Law and AI **August 2025 – Now**

Skills

- Programming languages: Python (Pandas, BeautifulSoup, Numpy, Scrapy, Sklearn), R (Dplyr, Lubridate, ggplot)
- Empirical methods for computational social science: Text classification, statistical testing (logistic regression, chi-square, confidence intervals), LLM output evaluation, persona-conditioned auditing
- Qualitative methods: MAXQDA, inductive coding, intercoder reliability testing
- Research synthesis: Structured literature review and comparative analysis across quantitative and qualitative studies
- Languages: English (proficient), German (C1 Goethe Zertifikat)

Additional Courses

Data Science Summer School (DS3), Hertie School Data Science Lab **August 2025**
Covered: R & Python programming, applied calculus & linear algebra, statistics & probability, machine learning, NLP, and AI agent design

References

Prof. Dr. Orestis Papakyriakopoulos, School of Governance, Technical University of Munich, orestis.p@tum.de
Dr. Isaac Bravo, School of Governance, Technical University of Munich, isaac.bravo@tum.de